

Literary Analysis - Building a Strong Paragraph

Course: English

Purpose

Literary analysis explains how specific choices in a text create meaning. A strong paragraph does more than identify a technique; it connects evidence to an interpretation.

Paragraph Structure

Claim: a focused analytical idea. **Evidence:** a short, relevant detail or quotation from the text. **Analysis:** explain how the evidence supports the claim and why it matters. **Connection:** connect the paragraph back to the thesis or larger argument.

Weak vs Strong Analysis

Weak: 'The author uses imagery here.' Stronger: explain what the imagery emphasizes, what response it creates, and how that contributes to the text's larger idea.

Using Evidence

Evidence should be integrated into your own sentence and followed by analysis. Avoid dropping a quotation into a paragraph without explaining its significance.

Revision Questions

- Does the topic sentence make an arguable claim?
- Is every piece of evidence relevant to that claim?
- Have I explained how the evidence supports my interpretation?
- Does the paragraph contribute to the essay's thesis?